

AMIT KUMAR PUNIA

ENGINEERING MANAGER | PLATFORM ARCHITECT

18+ Years • Engineering Manager • Distributed Systems • Architecture • Development • Engineering Leadership

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Technology and platform engineering leader with 18+ years of experience across software development, platform architecture, distributed systems and technical team leadership. A hands-on architect who has experienced the evolution from application development and high-traffic web platforms to large-scale streaming, analytics, cloud and multi-tenant ecosystems. Strong across the full technology chain—from requirements and system design through APIs, data platforms, infrastructure, integrations, scale, resilience and production operations. Brings a flexible leadership style shaped by both fast-moving environments and larger organisations: startup urgency and ownership combined with enterprise structure, governance and repeatability.

ARCHITECTURE & TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP STRENGTHS

- **Architecture:** scalable, resilient, maintainable system and platform design grounded in implementation realities.
- **Development:** hands-on foundation across GoLang, Python, PHP, NodeJS and web technologies.
- **Distributed Systems:** large clusters, multiple data centres, high availability and services scaled across hundreds of applications.
- **High-Scale Engineering:** streaming analytics handling billions of records/day and high-traffic platforms with millions of concurrent users/page views.
- **Platform Engineering:** reusable platforms serving multiple properties, products and applications.
- **Complex Integrations:** APIs, databases, messaging, caching, CDN, cloud, analytics, payment, content pipelines and third-party services.
- **Multi-Platform Delivery:** Web, Mobile/App and device-specific content and delivery requirements.
- **Team Management:** built teams from scratch, training/knowledge sharing, resource allocation and delivery leadership.
- **Automation:** strong focus on automating repetitive engineering and operational processes.
- **Business-to-Technology Translation:** converts product/business requirements into architecture and executable engineering priorities.

ORGANISATIONS, BRANDS & CAREER JOURNEY

Progression from hands-on software engineering into platform ownership, architecture and technical leadership across technology, media and streaming environments.

Organisation / Period	Role	Team
Warner Bros. Discovery Dec'2024–Jun'2025	Staff Software Engineer	5
SonyLIV Nov'2021–Nov'2024	Solution Architect	12
Tata Elxsi Jun'2020–Nov'2021	Solution Architect	10
CatchMedia Inc. Nov'2018–Jun'2020	Lead Architect	5
ZEE Entertainment May'2018–Nov'2018	Platform Manager (PM1)	15
Hungama Digital Media Oct'2015–May'2018	Platform Manager	10–15
Network18 Feb'2011–Oct'2015	Platform Manager / Technical Lead	8–10
mKLIK Mobile Solution Apr'2007–Feb'2011	Sr. Software Engineer / Software Engineer	4

SELECTED BRANDS, PLATFORMS & COMPLEX IMPLEMENTATIONS

SonyLIV — Streaming Analytics / Content Transcoding / Targeted Delivery

- Built analytics for plays, errors, concurrency and video-start time; content encoding/packaging; targeted playback URL selection based on device capability and bandwidth. GoLang, Python, ClickHouse, MongoDB, MySQL, Redis, Kafka, AWS Kinesis/Firehose.

SonyLIV — Multi-Profile Content Transcoding

- Built transcoding into multiple profiles for HLS, DASH and MSS streams. GoLang, Python, ClickHouse, MongoDB, MySQL, Redis, Kafka, AWS MediaConvert.

SonyLIV — Push Notification & Streaming API

- Built personalised notifications for Android, iOS and Web and an API Gateway for streaming SDK clients designed for heavy traffic.

ZEE5 — API / Payment / Coupon Platform

- Built shared API, payment and coupon platforms across App, Web and Mobile; also incorporated audience profiling and recommendation capabilities.

Hungama — Audience Profiling & Recommendation

- Built user-behaviour profiling to create personalised recommendation profiles.

Hungama — Payment Gateway

- Built subscription/rental payments across Web and Apps, integrating cards, net banking, wallets, telco billing, Google Play, App Store, coupons and Hungama Coins.

Hungama — Cross-Device Transcoding

- Built in-house transcoding for smartphones, feature phones, desktop, laptop and TV using AWS Spot and Auto Scale.

Hungama — API Gateway

- Built API Gateway with caching/GTM integration, targeting 99.9% uptime and supporting Hungama applications plus third-party integrations.

Hungama — Live Radio

- Built in-house live radio platform supporting 25+ channels across Web and App.

Network18 — Live Blog Platform

- Built reusable live-blog platform for News18, FirstPost and Moneycontrol for Budget, Election and sports events.

Network18 — Audience Profiling

- Built cross-property profiling across News18, IBNLive, FirstPost, Moneycontrol, Overdrive, Cricketnext and Burrp; integrated with ad networks.

Network18 — Real-Time Notifications

- Built shared push-notification platform across multiple apps, capable of reaching 5M users within 5 minutes with personalised notifications.

Network18 — Event Feeds & Caching

- Built Budget/Election/Cricket feed updates across Web, WAP and App with third-party integration and caching; CDN caching using Akamai, Redis and Couchbase.

Network18 — VAS / Operator Billing

- Integrated and improved billing with SDP for Airtel, DoCoMo, Reliance, Idea and Uninor, including real-time billing, callbacks, FTP dumps and WAP.

SCALE, COMPLEXITY & INTEGRATION EXPERIENCE

- Streaming analytics systems dealing with billions of records per day.
- High-traffic platforms supporting Elections, Budget and Live Cricket events with millions of concurrent users and page views.
- Large-scale clusters spanning multiple data centres; services scaled to hundreds of applications.
- Reusable and multi-tenant platforms designed across multiple properties and applications.
- REST API automation and API-driven service architecture.
- Cloud/infrastructure: AWS, GCP, CDN, Nginx, Varnish, Linux and Puppet.
- Data/messaging: Kafka, ClickHouse, Spark, MongoDB, Cassandra, Solr, Redis, Memcache, RabbitMQ and MemSQL.
- Operational focus on resiliency, resource utilisation, automation, scale and high availability.

LEADERSHIP & MANAGEMENT

- Developed teams from scratch, including knowledge sharing and employee training.
- Led teams, allocated resources and guided delivery through final implementation.
- Experience across teams of approximately 4–15 members.
- Combines hands-on technical intervention with delegation and team ownership.
- Comfortable in ambiguous, fast-moving environments while introducing structure as scale demands.
- Builds repeatable engineering practices rather than relying on individual heroics.
- Balances delivery urgency with architecture quality, operational resilience and maintainability.

THE VALUE OF 18+ YEARS

- Has experienced the evolution from conventional web applications to cloud, distributed systems, streaming, big data and multi-platform ecosystems.
- Understands that the hardest engineering challenges often sit in the integration between systems, data, platforms, people and operational processes.

- Brings architecture decisions grounded in real implementation experience—not architecture in isolation.
- Can anticipate where scale, resilience, caching, messaging, data volume and third-party dependencies may become bottlenecks.
- Moves comfortably from 0→1—creating new platforms—to 1→N—standardising and scaling them across products and teams.
- Combines startup hustle and ownership with enterprise governance, documentation and repeatability.
- At this level, value extends beyond coding: sound technical decisions, simplification of complexity, engineering mentorship, stakeholder alignment and scalable platforms.

CORE TECHNICAL STACK

Development: GoLang, Python, PHP 7.0, NodeJS, HTML5, JavaScript, AJAX, JSON, XML

Big Data / Distributed: ClickHouse, Spark, MemSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Cassandra, Solr

Database / Caching: MySQL, SQL Server, MemSQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, Redis, Memcache

Cloud / Infrastructure: AWS, GCP, Nginx, Apache, IIS, Varnish, CDN, Linux, Puppet

Frameworks / CMS / APIs: WordPress, CodeIgniter, Yii, MVC frameworks, RESTful Web Services, SOAP, XML, JSON

EDUCATION

- 2009 — GNIIT, Mumbai Churchgate
- 2007 — B.Com, IGNOU University